

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Seizures

MEDICAL / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Keep the person away from injury, time the seizure and do not restrain them or put anything in their mouth. Seek urgent help for a first seizure, one lasting over 5 minutes, repeated seizures without recovery, injury or breathing difficulty.

Do now.

**Make space**

01

Move dangerous objects away. Protect the head gently if possible, without holding the person down.

**Time and observe**

02

Note the start and stop times and whether there are repeated seizures. Ask someone to contact help when urgent criteria apply.

**Protect breathing afterward**

03

When safe, position on their side if breathing but not fully awake. Stay with them and monitor responsiveness.

**Act if normal breathing stops**

04

If unresponsive and not breathing normally, begin CPR and use an AED. Do not assume abnormal breathing is simply a normal recovery.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Continue protecting from hazards and observing breathing while a helper seeks medical access. Use prescribed rescue medicine only under the existing care plan and appropriate training. If urgent criteria apply, keep seeking care rather than leaving the person alone to recover.

Watch for.

Never force something into the mouth, give food or drink before fully alert, or restrain movements.

People & practical needs.

Reduce noise and spectators and give the person privacy. Afterward, speak calmly and explain what happened

Next decision.

Seek urgent help for seizures in water, during pregnancy, in a baby under 6 months or without return to baseline within 5–10 minutes. A known condition does not remove new warning signs.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

INCIDENT / SYMPTOM ONSET / LOCATION

HELP REQUESTED / RESPONSE CONFIRMED

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

American Red Cross – Seizures

AHA / Red Cross – 2024 first-aid guidelines

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/seizures/>